

24SMCV03288 24SMCV03288

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: I

Hearing date: 2026-06-29

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This is an application to continue the trial. The court's first question is whether this is an application by all parties, or only all defendants. The court will assume the former.

The basis is the recent death of lead counsel for one of the defendants. There are other reasons as well. The trial is currently set for the end of August.

The court warned the parties at the CMC that the trial would not be continued absent truly unforeseen and unforeseeable circumstances. But lead counsel's death—as well as the death of another lead counsel for a different defendant—would qualify. Accordingly, and assuming that this is a joint request by all parties to the litigation, the court is inclined to GRANT the request and VACATE the FSC and trial dates.

The court will hold a TSC at 8:30 am on August 24, 2026. The parties should meet and confer prior to that time to see if there are blocks of time that will work for them. The parties should also do their best to consult with the new parties in the case and to give notice to those parties of the TSC. The court will inquire only to ensure that the request is by all parties, and not just the defense.